

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Visible apex and managed strain

FRAME -> visible capacity and magnificence alongside managed fiscal strain

NOT -> simple golden age | NOT -> inevitable collapse already underway

STATE -> conquest, service, rank, revenue and ceremony remain effective

PRESSURE -> elite claims grow faster than realised resources

ADAPT -> salary cuts + muster ratios + month-scale + wider recruitment

BOUND -> Topic 23 acute crisis | Topic 25 post-1707 decline

VERDICT -> adaptation preserved capacity while redistributing pressure.

MUST REMEMBER: Shah Jahan (1628-58) governed through a changing mansab-jagir elite whose composition and costs require analysis.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Shah Jahan chronology, 1628-58

1627 -> Jahangir dies/succession transition | 1628 -> formal enthronement
1628-31 -> Bundela and Khan Jahan Lodi challenges
1632 -> Hugli | 1633/36 -> Deccan outcome | 1635 -> Peacock Throne
1638 -> Shahjahanabad | 1646-47 -> Balkh | 1649-53 -> Qandahar
1654 -> Chittor/Mewar tension | 1656-57 -> late Deccan pressure
1657-58 -> illness, succession war, confinement
DATE TRAP -> Mumtaz standard 1631; one assigned OCR narrative prints 1630.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The ruling class as a composite service elite

FORM -> mansab + office + jagir + court access + service + patronage

500 ZAT+ -> 123 in 1595 | 242 in 1621 | 443 in 1647-48 | 518 in 1656

IRANI-TURANI -> absolute growth; combined share 62.6% -> 52.12%

GROWTH -> Afghans + Indian Muslims + Rajputs + early Marathas

ADMIN -> Khatri + Kayastha + some Brahman service routes

TRAP -> immigrant Iranis/Turanis were not foreign state agents

RULE -> social category does not prove a fixed political faction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Recruitment, reproduction and faction

RECRUIT -> migration + regional incorporation + demonstrated competence

REPRODUCE -> kinship and patronage help, but mansab remains transferable service

IRANIS -> strong central-office presence | SADULLAH KHAN -> Indian Muslim wazir

RAJPUTS -> campaign commands persist; few governorships do not mean exclusion

DECCAN -> Habshi/Deccani/Maratha recruitment; stable alliance remains incomplete

FACTION -> person + patron + marriage + region + interest + survival

NOT -> Hindu/Muslim or Irani/Turani camps mechanically determine politics.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Mansabdari evolution and verification

ZAT -> status/pay grade | SAWAR -> cavalry obligation/pay claim
DAGH -> horse branding | CHEHRA -> descriptive troop roll
DU-ASPA SIH-ASPA -> double specified sawar component, never zat
BARAWARDI -> ordinary non-doubled portion in the worked rank
CONTRACT RATE -> paid to mansabdar; not uniform direct trooper wage
EVASION -> records/musters constrain fraud but do not eliminate it
ORIGIN -> Akbar foundation + Jahangir device + Shah Jahan systematisation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Jagir vocabulary: claim is not ownership

JAGIR -> transferable assignment to collect a revenue claim

NOT -> private ownership of village soil or hereditary territorial sovereignty

JAMA -> assessed paper revenue | HASIL -> realised collection

KHALISA -> revenue retained for imperial establishment

JAGIR LOCATION -> shapes service, collection cost and effective muster

TRANSFER -> prevents simple territorial entrenchment but creates insecurity

ANSWER RULE -> define claim, realisation, assignment and service separately.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: How the month-scale worked

SCALE -> 12-month | 10 | 8 | 6 | 4; Deccan could be 3-4

MEANING -> expected hasil as a fraction of paper jama

APPLIES -> zat pay + sawar pay + remount requirement

SAWAR EXAMPLE -> Rs 40 at 12 | Rs 30 at 8 | Rs 25 at 6

NOT PROPORTIONAL -> remount numbers also fall with the scale

FUNCTION -> align rank claims with imperfect jagir yield

TRAP -> adjustment/reduction, never a bonus.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: From paper rank to effective force

SAME PROVINCE -> roughly one-third of nominal sawar mustered

OUTSIDE PROVINCE -> roughly one-fourth

REMOTE BALKH/DECCAN -> one-fifth could apply

WORKED 2000/2000 -> 1000 du-aspa + outside jagir => $250 + 500 = 750$

NOMINAL RANK -> status and claim remain larger than field contingent

PEACE EFFECT -> reduced force less visible in stable North India

LATER RISK -> thin contingents become serious in prolonged Deccan disorder.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Expansion creates resources and claimants

JAMA -> 516.251 crore dams/100 in 1595-96 -> 912/176 in 1656-57

ELITE -> 500-zat+ mansabdars rise 123 -> 518, about 4.2 times

EXPANSION -> adds revenue assignments AND commanders, clients and garrisons

DECCAN -> inflated jama + weak hasil + subsidy needs

GAP -> rank/salary/service claims outrun productive jagir supply

ADAPT -> cuts + ratios + month-scale preserve operation

LIMIT -> early manifestation, not yet the mature jagirdari crisis.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Grandeur as political economy

FORMS -> Peacock Throne + Taj + Red Fort + Jama Masjid + Shahjahanabad

PURPOSE -> hierarchy + dynastic memory + paradise/order + court concentration

LABOUR/MATERIAL -> patronage and specialised production, not decoration alone

MOOSVI -> construction significant within khalisa expenditure

LIMIT -> source does not find a crippling drain on imperial/military finance

BOUNDARY -> Topic 24 owns complete architecture/economy survey

TRAP -> monuments cannot be declared the single cause of fiscal strain.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Architecture, including the Taj Mahal, is evidence of patronage and resources but not a substitute for ruling-class study.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Succession as a ruling-class stress test

1657 ILLNESS -> rumour converts four provincial-princely bases into armies

DARA -> designation and extraordinary rank; favour does not create primogeniture

SHUJA/MURAD -> self-coronation | AURANGZEB-MURAD -> contingent alliance

NOBLES/RAJPUTS -> align through service ties, interest, calculation and survival

DHARMAT + SAMUGARH -> military outcomes decide access to throne

RELIGION -> rhetoric/outlook matter; not a liberal-orthodox plebiscite

ENDPOINT -> Aurangzeb prevails, Shah Jahan confined; Topic 22 begins.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: The 1657 succession crisis arose within dynastic and fiscal structures; it was not governed by primogeniture.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 21 final answer spine

DEFINE -> composite ranked service elite + mansab-jagir fiscal mechanism

TRACE -> 1628 consolidation -> magnificence -> external limits -> 1657 stress

DATA -> elite 123 to 518 | jama index 100 to 176

MECHANISM -> salary cuts + du-aspa + muster fractions + month-scale

QUALIFY -> architecture significant, not fiscally ruinous by itself

PYQ -> zero direct Topic-21 CSE routes, 2018-2026; Mains has no key

BOUND -> Topics 18/19 campaigns | 23 crisis | 24 culture | 25 decline

VERDICT -> apex capacity coexisted with adaptive structural pressure.